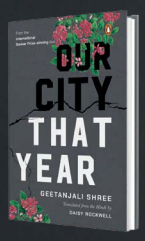
TEXT AND THE CITY

International Booker Prize winner **Geetanjali Shree** is back with a newly translated book–*Our City That Year*



OUR CITY THAT YEAR
by Geetanjali Shree; translated by Daisy Rockwell
PENGUIN HAMISH HAMILTON
₹**699; 432** pages

Q. Can you tell us briefly what *Our City That Year* is about?
The book traces the corrosion of common human decency and the growth of a divisive relationship full of mutual suspicion, intolerance and violence and hatred between the two major communities that have coexisted in this country for centuries. It worries about the rise of narrow prejudices which have begun to colour the language even of the so-called secularists.

Q. How involved were you in the translation process?
Daisy [Rockwell] and I have developed a wonderful rapport. We go into discussions and clarifications alongside the translation and then the final call is taken. Usually hers, unless I have a huge objection, which is rare.

Q. How do you view translation? Do you feel certain nuances get lost in translation?
A world without translation would be an impoverished place. There are always things that are difficult to translate. But that is precisely the translators' challenge and the litmus test of their imagination and creativity. Good translation is also transcreation. Some things may be lost, but things will also be gained. And the work reaches out to that many more people.

Q. Are you working on any new novel at the moment?
Yes, it is ready for publication. Its name is *Sah-sa*. Giving it a slow, last look. Read it!

–with Amit Dixit

Photograph by **CHANDRADEEP KUMAR**